

Education

- **University of Washington** 2020–2026
Ph.D. in Computer Science and Engineering
Advisors: Ranjay Krishna and Alexander Ratner
Committee Members: Ali Farhadi and Luke Zettlemoyer
- **University of Illinois Urbana–Champaign** 2017–2020
B.S. in Statistics and Computer Science

Research Interests

My research focuses on grounded vision–language models: building AI models and systems that connect perception, language, and physical reality. More broadly, I study how multimodal models can form rich, robust, and structured correspondences across modalities, enabling AI systems to perceive, follow instructions, anticipate motion, and interact with the world.

Honors and Awards

- ML and Systems Rising Star, MLCommons 2025
- OpenAI Superalignment Fellowship 2024
- Apple Scholars in AI/ML Ph.D. Fellowship, Data-Centric AI Track 2024
- Oral Presentation and Award Candidate, CVPR (*Molmo2*) 2026
- Compute Transparency Champion, CVPR (*Molmo2*) 2026
- Best Paper Award, Structural Priors for Vision Workshop at ICCV 2025
- Best Paper Award, LLM Agents Workshop at ICLR 2024
- Best Paper Award, IEEE ICDM 2020
- CRA Outstanding Undergraduate Researcher, Honorable Mention 2020
- James Scholar Preble Research Award, UIUC 2019
- John R. Pasta Outstanding Undergraduate Award, UIUC 2019

Selected Publications

(* indicates equal contribution. For a complete publication list, please visit my [Google Scholar page](#).)

1. [NeurIPS’26] **Jieyu Zhang***, Ziqi Gao*, Luke Zettlemoyer, and Ranjay Krishna, “Vision–Language Grounding as Bidirectional Concept Correspondence,” *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems*, 2026.
2. [CVPR’26, **Award Candidate**] Christopher Clark*, **Jieyu Zhang***, Zixian Ma*, Jae Sung Park*, Mohammadreza Salehi, Rohun Tripathi, Sangho Lee, Jason Ren, Chris Dongjoo Kim, Yinuo Yang, Vincent Shao, Yue Yang, Weikai Huang, Ziqi Gao, Taira Anderson, Jianrui Zhang, Jitesh Jain, George Stoica, Winston Han, Ali Farhadi, and Ranjay Krishna, “Molmo2: Open Weights and Data for Vision–Language Models with Video Understanding and Grounding,” *IEEE/CVF Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition*, 2026. *Oral Presentation and Compute Transparency Champion*.
3. [ICCV’25, **Highlight**] Chenhao Zheng, **Jieyu Zhang**, Mohammadreza Salehi, Ziqi Gao, Vishnu Iyengar, Norimasa Kobori, Quan Kong, and Ranjay Krishna, “One Trajectory, One Token: Grounded Video Tokenization via Panoptic Sub-object Trajectory,” *IEEE/CVF International Conference on Computer Vision*, 2025.
4. [NeurIPS’24] **Jieyu Zhang**, Weikai Huang, Zixian Ma, Oscar Michel, Dong He, Tanmay Gupta, Wei-Chiu Ma, Ali Farhadi, Aniruddha Kembhavi, and Ranjay Krishna, “Task Me Anything,” *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems*, 2024. *Oral Presentation at the Video-Language Models Workshop*.
5. [NeurIPS’23] Cheng-Yu Hsieh*, **Jieyu Zhang***, Zixian Ma, Aniruddha Kembhavi, and Ranjay Krishna, “SugarCrepe: Fixing Hackable Benchmarks for Vision–Language Compositionality,” *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems*, 2023.

Teaching Experience

- **Co-Instructor, CSE 455: Computer Vision, University of Washington.** Delivered undergraduate lectures and developed instructional material connecting geometric and learning-based foundations with modern computer vision models.

- **Research Mentor, CSE 492R: CSE Group Research, University of Washington.** Designed and scoped a quarter-long project for a four-student undergraduate team; established baselines and milestones, held weekly meetings, and guided the team to a completed research poster.
- **Teaching Assistant, CS 599C: Training Data Management and Weak Supervision, University of Washington.** Graded assignments, held office hours, and helped graduate students debug technical work.

Advising and Mentorship

Selected mentees; I have directly mentored more than 30 pre-doctoral researchers in total.

- Weikai Huang, undergraduate student at UW. Next: Ph.D. student at UW. Recipient of the UW Outstanding Allen School Senior Award.
- Ziqi Gao, M.S. student at UW and Predoctoral Young Investigator at AI2. Next: Ph.D. student at UW.
- Zhengyu Hu, M.S. student at HKUST. Next: Ph.D. student at UW.
- Rishi Bathina, undergraduate student at UW. Next: Google.
- Chengkai Hou, M.S. student at Jilin University. Next: Ph.D. student at Peking University.
- Linxin Song, M.S. student at Waseda University. Next: Ph.D. student at USC.
- Jinyan Su, undergraduate student at UESTC. Next: Ph.D. student at Cornell University.
- Mandy Wang, undergraduate student at UIUC. Next: Ph.D. student at UCLA.
- Minhao Jiang, undergraduate student at UIUC. Next: M.S. student at UIUC.
- Xiangchen Song, undergraduate student at UIUC. Next: Ph.D. student at Carnegie Mellon University.
- Hosted weekly one-on-one open office hours for more than two years, advising 100+ students worldwide on research, Ph.D. applications, and career development.
- Mentor, UW CSE Pre-Application Mentorship Service (PAMS), providing individualized guidance and encouragement to prospective Ph.D. applicants.

Research and Industry Experience

- | | |
|---|--------------|
| • Microsoft
<i>Researcher</i> | 2026–present |
| • Allen Institute for AI (AI2)
<i>Research Intern</i> | 2025–2026 |
| • Salesforce Research
<i>Research Intern</i> | 2024 |
| • Microsoft Research
<i>Research Intern</i> | 2023 |
| • Microsoft Research Asia
<i>Star Bridge Research Assistant</i> | 2020–2021 |
| • ByteDance AI Lab
<i>Research Intern</i> | 2020 |

Professional Service

- Lead organizer, Synthetic Data for Computer Vision Workshop at CVPR, 2024–2026.
- Area Chair / Program Committee: ACL Rolling Review and COLM.
- Reviewer: NeurIPS, ICML, ICLR, AAAI, IJCAI, CVPR, ACL, EMNLP, ARR, AISTATS, KDD, and LOG.